

MEQ PRACTICE QUESTIONS (CASE STUDIES)

MODIFIED ESSAY QUESTION 1

Olivia is a 29-year-old, married mother of three children aged twelve months to eight years. She experienced significant sexual abuse in her childhood. Olivia has just been discharged to the local community mental health team at which you work, following a three-month admission to a nearby acute psychiatric inpatient unit.

Prior to admission Olivia became depressed after hearing that her brother had been found guilty of sexually assaulting his stepdaughter. She developed flashbacks and nightmares of her own experiences of abuse and had frequent panic attacks. She was found by her oldest child with a cord around her neck and admitted to hospital.

Her hospital admission was characterised by recurrent episodes of self-harm including lacerating her arms and tying cords around her neck. She was treated with Sodium Valproate, paroxetine and diazepam. Olivia was eventually discharged on these medications and is still symptomatic.

a) Discuss the immediate and longer-term psychiatric interventions you would suggest for Olivia's previous sexual abuse. Please give reasons for your choices.

b) Discuss the interventions you would use to support Olivia's family. Please give reasons for your choices.

Olivia has found out that she is pregnant as a result of having sex with her husband when on weekend leave from the hospital. She and her husband are concerned about the effects of psychotropic medication on the baby.

c) Outline the information and options you would discuss with Olivia and her husband. Please provide adequate detail.

MODIFIED ESSAY QUESTION 2

Emile, a refugee from Serbia came to Australia 20 years ago. His parents and younger brother were killed eight years ago while seeking asylum before coming to Australia. He witnessed multiple atrocities and trauma. He lives with his wife and two teenage children at home. His general practitioner referred him to you as he has been feeling teary with chronic headaches and sleep disturbances. His general practitioner has investigated his headaches.

a) Outline your differentials

b) Outline your assessment process.

c) What collateral information would you require?

During your assessment you have found no psychiatric diagnosis. He states that his wife has been busy with her work and his two teenage sons are not interested in cultural activities which he finds very frustrating.

d) During your assessment, you found no psychiatric diagnosis. He states that his wife has been busy with her work and his two teenage sons that are not interested in cultural activity which he finds very frustrating. Outline your management plan.